

Board of Works September 2, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eZWnl8q5-zM
Publication Date	2026-09-03T01:27:40Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Board of Public Works and Safety Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: September 2, [Year]

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Ted Baker called the regular meeting of the Board of Public Works and Safety to order at [00:00:50](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Ted Baker (Presiding Officer), Lola, and Barb.
 - **Absent:** None explicitly noted.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance led by the board [00:00:54](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the August 26th meeting were presented and approved by voice vote [00:01:20](#).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:01:36 Register of Claims

- **Presenter:** Matt Waggley, City Controller.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Matt Waggley presented the register of claims, noting that the largest claims were healthcare-related, which have been consolidated across funds outside the general fund that maintain their own revenue streams. An additional notable claim included a \$70,000 expense for asbestos abatement at the Forest Park Senior Citizens Center. Board members expressed appreciation for the detailed explanations provided in staff emails.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **00:04:31 Rick Yenser** questioned why government funds were being used for environmental cleanup on property owned/run by a non-profit that was given to a New York developer, and inquired about the exact amount of the cleanup.
 - **Mayor:** Responded that several funders faced financial challenges running the facility. The private purchaser agreed to buy and invest several hundred thousand dollars to expand the facility, bring in additional veteran services, and keep the senior center as a tenant. The \$70,000 edit fund investment ensures the senior center remains in place without moving expenses, allowing them to focus on programming.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:07:11**.
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00:07:19 Temporary Parking Request: 2354 West Warwick Road

- **Presenter:** Andrew Seager.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Andrew Seager requested temporary parking for an upcoming celebration party. During discussion, it was revealed the event is a book-signing party celebrating the publication of his archaeological book published by Harvard University Press (release date October 6th).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:09:31**.
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00:09:40 Temporary Parking Request: 901 North Brier

- **Presenter:** Resident / Applicant.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The applicant requested temporary street parking because the neighborhood has a no-parking restriction due to its proximity to Ball State University, preventing guests from parking on the street during a meeting of the "Conversation Club," where members gather to hear and discuss annual presentations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:10:46**.
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00:10:49 Memorandum of Understanding: City of Muncie and Ball State University – Martin Street Maintenance and Operations

- **Presenter:** The Mayor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Mayor presented an MOU detailing a partnership between the city and Ball State University regarding Martin Street in “The Village.” Ball State will take over maintenance and capital structures for Martin Street from University Avenue north to Ashland Street (where a former bank building was demolished to create an open public space). Additionally, Ball State will maintain landscaping from University Avenue south to the White River. The city will continue to maintain the actual street pavement.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:14:22.
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00:14:28 Street Closure Application: Indiana Black Expo Muncie Chapter Annual Parade

- **Presenter:** Latasha Bonds.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Latasha Bonds requested a rain date (September 12th) for the summer celebration parade, which was originally rained out on August 1st. The event will coincide with National Voter Registration Day. The parade route starts at South Walnut, turns left to Willard, right to Hackley, and left to 9th Street to Heekin Park.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:15:43.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:15:54 **Zane Bishop:** Addressed the board regarding a \$2.4 million street rebuild on Columbus Avenue (specifically McKinley from Walnut to Madison). He criticized multiple issues with the project, including misplaced stop signs, tripping hazards for utility access, outdated traffic poles, improperly placed pedestrian signals, poorly marked and flooding crosswalks, out-of-date parking signage, storm grates interfering with accessible parking, non-ADA-compliant Cardinal Greenway access, and a lack of landscaping. He questioned the city's prioritization of this project over core corridors and transit infrastructure.
 - 00:18:32 **Rick Yenser:** Raised concerns regarding the growing presence and funding of automated block surveillance cameras around the hospital and university. He cited opposition in other cities (such as Fort Wayne) and noted that the city has spent over \$300,000 on surveillance in recent years, urging the board to rethink and reconsider the program.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None made.

- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned by Presiding Officer Ted Baker following public comment [00:19:24](#).

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